Rosemary with Ginger

By Edward Allen Baker

GINGER: ...cause we're closed...for good...don't matta since when...Mrs. Guertin, listen to me...I can't give you the soup-of-the-day cause there is none...that's right...so you have to stop callin' an...no-no I'm not foolin' you...I'm here just cleanin' up an... *(Knocking heard on the front door. Ginger turns to look.)* Uh, listen Mrs. Guertin you take care a yaself...I will uh-huh bye... *(Ginger hangs up and proceeds to the door.)*

INTRODUCTION

GINGER (in character): . . . . (To audience) Hi, I'm Ginger and that's my sister . . . Rosemary .

(praying) I have a confession to make before I let her in, God. I don't know sometimes why I keep trying. But she is my sister and in spite of everything, I do love her. I suppose I should just be glad that she came tonight at all. Maybe this one time we can work together to accomplish something good for a change. Please, God, bring us together tonight. I need a family and I know Rosemary does. Lord, God . . Give me strength and patience and well, LOTS of patience.

(To audience) Rosemary with Ginger by Edward Allen Baker

GINGER: *(She turns the clump of keys and lets in Rosemary.)* Where you been?

ROSEMARY: You gotta be outta your mind still bein' here...

GINGER: You been drinkin, haven't you? I can smell the blackberry brandy, Rose...

ROSEMARY: Listen.

GINGER: I don't wanna listen if you're on one of your drinkin' binges an...

ROSEMARY: Yeah well... Me and Raymond the oran-ga-tan man got into this big fight an he's like screamin in my face not lettin' me talk so he goes like "yeah well you're outta here!" So I busted every mirra in the house...

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GINGER: Really if you don't wanna do this with me then...

ROSEMARY: I'm here! *(beat)* I'm here...

GINGER: I thought we should do somethin' for Ma, yunno, cause lately she's been gettin depressed an nothin goes good for her...then there's you. *(Rosemary picks up a piece of paper from the table and reads.)*

ROSEMARY: "Unsung Mother of the Month Award."

GINGER: If she wins they'll give her a five hundred dollar gift certificate to the Shoppers World.

ROSEMARY: You do most of the writin' it, I'm just hidin' from the oranga-tan man whose gotta be losin his mind about now with no mirras an I flushed his diet pills down the toilet an just for the hell of it I beat the crap outta his mailbox!

GINGER: *(beat)* So you did drop outta A-A...

ROSEMARY: People with their sob stories an-an everybody wants to hug an hug an pray an pray, it's like my worst nightmare. Rememba when Dad used to say- there's nothin worse than bein around reformed drunks?

GINGER: You're just like 'im, it's unbelievable.

ROSEMARY: An that's bad?

GINGER: Yeah he's dead.

ROSEMARY: Oh cut it out, will ya?

GINGER: How soon you forget the horrors you went through an how you almost died an how you couldn't stop throwin up, Jesus Rose!

ROSEMARY: It's unda control... *(drinks)* An I don't want to talk about it. *(finishes drink)*

GINGER: *(looks down to paper)* Let's start this thing...

ROSEMARY: You still on the couch?

GINGER: YES I'm still on the couch!

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ROSEMARY: I woulda thrown him out if it was...

GINGER: I got three kids an no money an nowheres to go so what am I gonna do?

ROSEMARY: I'd sleep in a shelter before I'd...

GINGER: I put it past me cause...I-I have to, okay? I can't leave him right now. You haven't told anybody, have you?

ROSEMARY: Nobody would believe it so why bother. Look, sorry I brought it up.

GINGER: I hate it when you drink, I really do. You get that look in your eyes that's nothin but trouble. Me an Harry got a problem an I made the big mistake a tellin you an then you think you can throw it up in my face anytime you want-withwith that smirk that goes with it! We're gonna deal with it when...when we can an which is more than you're doin...

ROSEMARY: I deal.

GINGER: Yeah yeah right yeah you deal...

ROSEMARY: I do. I don't let nothin slide.

GINGER: Yeah dealin for you is bustin mirras in your boyfriend's house an-an back to drinkin afta almost dyin and fightin with your first husband an his new wife over the kids that you... *(Stops short. Beat beat.)*

ROSEMARY: That I what?

GINGER: That you yunno just...just not bein stable somewhere, I don't know...

ROSEMARY: I love my kids. You sayin I don't love my kids?

GINGER: I would never say that, god...

ROSEMARY: Never?

GINGER: No! You got that look on your face again.

ROSEMARY: You tell the truth, don't you? Like you an Brad havin a little talk about Rosemary. *(Rosemary pulls out an official-looking letter from her pocketbook.)*

GINGER: I . . .we...

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ROSEMARY: I woke up this mornin to a sheriff servin me with an affidavit from Brad *(looking at the letter)* Um... "an my ex-sista in law Ginger Willis is in agreement with my decision to pursue custody of the children. In our phone conversations she agrees with me that the children's safety and well-being is in danger if my exwife is drinking."

GINGER: Oh god....

ROSEMARY: "...my ex-sista-in-law spoke at length of Rosemary's past drinkin' problems stating to me that her sister's mental condition has gotten worse since being with Raymond Perretti, her live-in boyfriend who owns the nightclub Memories and likes to drink and party..."

GINGER: Rose, he's really worried an-an.... He called an I...

ROSEMARY: I'm outta here....

GINGER: Listen to me Rose. Rosemary look at me! I...Brad called me an we talked or he did most a the talkin an I don't know what you got in your head about it but it was...he talked about a temporary custody thing an wondrin when you're gonna get help. I-I think he is really worried, uh I don't think he's tryin to be mean or anyway...um... (Pause.)

ROSEMARY: I...I...keep hearin...my my kids' voices...

GINGER: I know...

ROSEMARY: "Mommy, where are we goin?" "Mommy, why are you drivin so fast?" "Mommy, please don't drive so fast."

GINGER: Rose...

ROSEMARY: "Just be quiet an-an Laurie make sure your seat belt is on tight... "

GINGER: What are you?

ROSEMARY: "Mommy, it's scary...you're scarin me..." "mommy, why'd you take us outta school, mommy please we want daddy..."

GINGER: This happened?

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ROSEMARY: "We're goin to Rocky Point Cliffs kids. Daddy says I never do any thin with you kids so we're going to Rocky Point Cliffs an look out over the ocean, okay?"

GINGER: *(nervously)* When did this happen?

ROSEMARY: "Even Auntie Ginger says I'm not a good mother."

GINGER: What are you talkin about?!

ROSEMARY: "But mommy we go to school today, we got masks to make for Halloween an...mommy bring us back!"

GINGER: Are they in the car?! *(Ginger runs to the window and looks out.)*

ROSEMARY: "You sit down Laurie! I am your mother so you listen to me, now sit before I.."

GINGER: Stop it Rose!

ROSEMARY: "I am your mother. I am your mother..."

GINGER: You stop it goddamn it!

ROSEMARY: "It's too windy up here mommy...the water is so...is so gray..." *(Ginger grabs a coin from the counter then runs to the payphone.)* "I'm your mother, kids...don't be afraid of me, no need to be afraid of me..." *(Ginger is dialing.)* "Just look out, okay, not down...look straight out."

GINGER: *(on phone)* C'mon, pick up, pick up...

ROSEMARY: "Okay, now hold hands kids...an-an I'm gonna step over here..."

GINGER: Hello! Brad!

ROSEMARY: "...cause I wanna take your piture..."

GINGER: Listen, where are the kids?

ROSEMARY: "Laurie...step back hon...you're still too close to mommy..."

GINGER: Call the school then call me at the diner! *(hangs up the phone)*

ROSEMARY: "...now c'mon back up for your mother...I want the best picture I can get to show people my kids..."

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GINGER: You cut it out Rose!

ROSEMARY: "Nice one, now I want ya to turn around so I get a picture a you both lookin out over the ocean..."

GINGER: I never said those things!

ROSEMARY: "I'm gettin closer okay, but don't turn around an look at me..."

GINGER: He just put that stuff in there!

ROSEMARY: "Laurie, don't look at Mommy I said!" *(Ginger turns to face the phone.)*

GINGER: Please god no don't let this happen oh god, oh god I....

ROSEMARY: "I'm right behind you now don't move an don't look back 'an"

(Phone rings. Ginger gets it.)

GINGER: Yeah!

ROSEMARY: "Here we go, ready?"

GINGER: *(listens, calmer)* Okay, yeah nothin I... *(Ginger turns to look at Rosemary. Rosemary picks up her drink and drinks.)*

ROSEMARY: Ah, that hit the spot...

GINGER: *(on phone)* ...sure bye... *(to Rosemary)* I don't believe what you just did!

ROSEMARY: You're helpin 'im take my kids from me.

GINGER: No!

ROSEMARY: You turned against me...

GINGER: *(suddenly)* WHO was at your house when you couldn't stop throwin up and WHO called the rescue squad an WHO cleaned up the blood you was spittin up?! It was me who stopped you from jumpin out the winda an it was me who sat on you screamin for the nurse while you spit in my face an afta three days a that I stood back an saw you gettin all the flowers an everybody loves Rosemary an Rosemary says "Ginger put these over there" an "Ginger watch for the nurses while I sneak a smoke" an I did it but deep down I was there waitin for a hey-by-the-way-thanks-for-what-you-did-

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for-me but Rosemary was too busy to notice her only sister who as usual took time from her own family to be with Rosemary cause Rosemary needed me... *(Rosemary is preparing herself to leave.)* "No Harry I can't, I gotta help Rosemary move..." "I'll be right back, I gotta pick up Rose's kids..." "Harry, nobody can find Rose so I gotta go..." *(Rosemary straightens up.)* Then that day that stupid thing with Harry happened... If I leave him where do I go? An-an what about the kids . . . shit, I-I go out there an what? Look for a guy an say save me-please an oh by the way I got three kids an I been...! been havin anxiety attacks an oh yeah oh yeah...I-L..I was told that I got uh two lumps...in my right breast... *(Rosemary looks up at Ginger.)* That's where I was before I...I was at the uh Doctor Ferrante an...I even joked with him cause his hands felt so warm on my...an I said somethin like um..,Jesus maybe I shoulda picked up a bottle of wine 'fore I came, right, an uh he didn't seem to hear me...he just kept pressin' this one spot an I could see in his eyes that uh oh...what's a matta? An he told me...not one lump...but two an I cried right there an he he was nice enough to um hold me for a minute an I...all I was thinkin' was about my kids an wantin' to be in my house with my family an I somehow managed to drive an I walk in feelin' uh light-headed an I catch Harry an uh...

(BEAT)

GINGER: *(Rosemary is visibly upset. Ginger steps closer to her with a smirk. Rosemary realizes Ginger's entire story has been a lie)* Rose, I'm just gonna say it. You're a real real shitty mother an you're a drunk that's made you into a maniac but you know what? I'm gonna tell you somethin right here an it probly goes back to when we was kids when you would hum

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a song close to my ear when mom and dad were fighting so I wouldn't hear 'em but I love you as much as I love my kids, I'd give you my last breath an... Sorry for gettin' sappy here an I would never turn against you. Never. I said things to Brad that well I shoulda been sayin' to you but I chickened out cause in your way you can make people afraid to say what should be said. Like Dad was. *(beat)* I won't hug you or nothin' cause I know you hate that... *(beat)* You all right?

ROSEMARY: Yeah-yeah... *(beat)* I'm just...yunno I'm afraid...

GINGER: Makes two of us

ROSEMARY: Brad's probly gonna get custody, huh?

GINGER: Yeah Rose, probly. But it's a temporary thing.

ROSEMARY: Yeah. *(beat)* I'll bounce back.

GINGER: You always do. *(Beat. Rosemary extends her hand out to her sister.)*

ROSEMARY: Hang on Ginger... *(Ginger grabs hold of her sister's hand.)*

GINGER: I'm hangin' on Rosemary....

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